

Recall Technical, Parts & Warranty Handling Procedure

Document Owner: Technical Operations / Warranty

Primary Users: Technical Support, Warranty Administrators, Workshops, Parts Operations

Process Area: Recall Diagnosis, Repair Authorization & Claim Processing

Document Status: Internal Operating Procedure

1. Overview

The technical and warranty process begins after a potentially affected vehicle has been identified by the dealer. The purpose of this procedure is to establish whether the campaign action applies, determine the correct repair, ensure appropriate parts are used, and provide the evidence necessary to settle the associated warranty or recall claim.

The dealer is responsible for confirming the customer's vehicle details before submitting a claim. Technical Operations is responsible for resolving technical uncertainty and interpreting campaign instructions where the standard repair procedure does not adequately address the vehicle condition.

2. Campaign Verification

The technician must verify the VIN against the campaign applicability information. Where the vehicle has multiple campaigns, each campaign should be checked independently.

The technician should review the latest technical campaign bulletin, repair instruction, parts list, and relevant service information. Printed workshop instructions may not always reflect the most recent revision. Where a discrepancy exists, the electronic manufacturer-controlled version takes precedence.

Some older campaign references remain visible in dealer systems after an updated campaign has replaced them. Warranty administrators should therefore verify the campaign revision before submitting a claim.

3. Diagnostic Assessment

Not every recall requires diagnosis. Some campaigns specify a direct component replacement or software update. Others require inspection or testing before a repair decision can be made.

Where diagnostic activity is required, the technician should document:

- Diagnostic trouble codes
- Inspection results
- Measured values
- Component condition
- Photographs where required
- Software or calibration version
- Relevant manufacturing or component information
- Technician findings

If the identified condition does not match the expected failure mode, the technician should not automatically proceed with component replacement.

A technical case may be required where:

1. The component has already been replaced under the same campaign.
2. The vehicle displays symptoms not described in the campaign bulletin.
3. The specified repair does not resolve the issue.
4. The required part is unavailable.
5. The vehicle contains a modified or non-standard component.
6. There is evidence of secondary damage.
7. The repair requires additional labour beyond the published allowance.

4. Parts Availability

Parts Operations is responsible for monitoring campaign parts availability and distribution. A campaign may be technically open but not immediately repairable if the required part has not been released or distributed.

The warranty administrator should not classify a campaign as completed solely because the vehicle has been inspected.

Where a part is backordered, the dealer should record the vehicle against the campaign and retain the customer contact requirement. Priority allocation may apply to vehicles subject to a safety restriction.

Parts may occasionally be superseded. When this occurs, the replacement part number should be used only where the manufacturer parts system confirms compatibility.

5. Repair Authorization

Standard recall repairs do not normally require individual technical authorization when performed exactly according to the published campaign instructions.

Additional authorization may be required for:

- Non-standard labour
- Additional components
- Secondary damage
- Repeat repairs
- Vehicle immobilization
- Alternative repair methods
- Engineering modifications
- Repairs outside the campaign's standard VIN or configuration parameters

The authorization request should contain sufficient evidence for Technical Operations to make a decision. Submissions stating only “vehicle has issue” may be returned to the dealer for additional information.

Urgent safety cases should be escalated through the emergency technical support route rather than waiting for the normal warranty queue.

6. Warranty / Recall Claim

The warranty administrator shall create the claim using the applicable campaign code, operation number, labour time, parts, and supporting documentation.

The claim should correspond to the actual work performed. For example, if the published campaign operation specifies a component replacement but the dealer performs additional unrelated work during the same visit, the unrelated work must remain outside the recall claim unless separately authorized.

Potential claim rejection reasons include:

- Incorrect VIN
- Incorrect campaign code
- Invalid operation number
- Missing evidence
- Incorrect part number
- Duplicate claim
- Repair performed before campaign activation
- Repair performed after applicable campaign closure
- Labour exceeding published allowance without approval

- Previously completed repair
- Vehicle not eligible

7. Repeat Repairs

Repeat campaign repairs require particular attention. If the same component fails after completion of a recall repair, the dealer should review the previous repair history before submitting a new claim.

The technical team may request the removed component, photographs, diagnostic records, or additional testing. Depending on the failure, the issue may be classified as:

- Normal campaign completion
- Repeat campaign repair
- Product-quality investigation
- Warranty repair outside the campaign
- Customer-pay repair
- Engineering investigation

The classification should not be determined solely by the dealer based on commercial convenience.

8. Engineering Escalation

Cases showing repeated failures across vehicles should be flagged to Product Quality or Engineering. A single dealer may not have enough information to identify a broader product issue, therefore campaign cases may be aggregated centrally.

Engineering may issue revised instructions while the campaign remains active. When revised instructions are released, dealers should use the latest applicable revision for vehicles that have not yet been repaired.

Vehicles already repaired under an earlier valid instruction should not automatically be recalled again unless the manufacturer determines that the previous action was insufficient.

9. Final Technical Verification

Before a campaign is closed on the vehicle, the technician must confirm that the repair was completed according to the applicable instruction.

Required checks may include:

- Functional test

- Diagnostic scan
- Calibration
- Software confirmation
- Torque verification
- Leak check
- Road test
- Visual inspection

The exact checks depend on the campaign.

Where a repair cannot be verified, the vehicle should remain in an unresolved status. Warranty administrators should not close a claim merely to clear an aging-worklist report.

10. Operational Exceptions

In practice, claims may be returned several times due to missing photographs, incorrect operation codes, outdated campaign references, or differences between dealer and manufacturer systems.

Where a claim is rejected, the warranty administrator should first determine whether the rejection is administrative or technical. Administrative corrections should be made without unnecessarily reopening the technical repair. Technical rejections should be escalated where evidence indicates that the repair was valid.

Related Documents:

See [01_Dealer_Customer_Recall_Operations](#) for customer booking, vehicle reception, and dealer communications.

See [03_Compliance_Finance_Recall_Closure](#) for financial settlement, regulatory reporting, and campaign closure criteria.